



THE FROZEN SOUTH



Antarctica, the land that surrounds the South Pole, is almost empty. The layer of ice 1.2 miles (two kilometers) thick, howling winds, and freezing temperatures stop plants and land-living animals from surviving. Yet the ocean around this frozen land is full of fish and krill, so the coasts are home to millions of birds. Penguins are the best-known residents of the snowy south, but there are also seabirds such as skuas, petrels, and terns.



Chinstrap penguin

Belly flop

The quickest way to get around on slippery ice is to slide. Penguins can't use a sled like you, so they scoot along on their big bellies!



They push themselves along with their strong feet and wings.

These Adélie penguins may have to slip and slide up to 60 miles (100 kilometers) from their nesting colonies to the sea.



Egg thief

Skuas rarely go hungry because there are plenty of penguin eggs and chicks for them to steal. While one skua distracts the parent penguins, the other one grabs a meal.

They can't fly, but penguins are excellent swimmers.

Adélies eat small animals called krill.

